



EMOTIONS AND ECONOMIC DECISION MAKING

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General Introduction

In this philosophical world, there has always been a question about ‘What makes us human.’ To be more precise ‘What makes us different from other beings?’ Aristotle upheld that rationality makes us human. This emphasizes the fact that we are able to reflect about ourselves and the world around us. We are able to make judgments, coordinate among other human beings, adapt to new situations, and survive the most adverse conditions posed by the environment. However, I was asking myself, ‘Is my rationality depending on some other factors?’

There is an interesting case of Phineas Gage. He was a railroad worker in the United States. In 1848 he had an accident during his work. While setting an explosive for blasting the rocks, a metal bar flew into his left jaw and came out through his skull. Surprisingly he survived and the people were curious about his recovery. The doctors examined him and came into a conclusion that Phineas has lost the ability to experience emotion. He had neither happiness nor sorrow. The researchers soon observed that the behavior of Phineas has also undergone changes. He started to make irrational decisions and some of the stupidest choices. At last, they noted that human emotions had a role to play in the decision-making process.¹

In this research paper, I set out on an enquiry about the role of emotions in human behavior where we speculate into the relationship between emotions and choices. Behavioral Economics is the field of study chosen to provide a framework for this thesis paper. The terms ‘judgement’ and ‘choice’ are used in this thesis to denote decision-making. ‘Economic decisions’ in this thesis; are the decisions that involve monetary transactions and the exchange of goods and services. The main argument, which I would propose, is that the emotions have a role in economic decision-making.

In the first chapter, the concept of emotions is understood from the perspective of an ordinary person and philosophically examined. Some prominent theories on emotions are also described to have a conceptual clarity. In the second chapter, the discipline of behavioral economics is chosen as a background to study about decision

¹David Hume, “Emotion and moods,” *Organizational Behavior* (United Kingdom: Pearson, 2012), 263. <https://www.pearsonhighered.com/assets/samplechapter/0/1/3/2/0132431564.pdf> (Accessed on 12-07-2024).

making and its relation with emotions. Behavioral Economics asserts that human behavior plays an important role² in economic analyses. I have included the study of consumer decisions to highlight the influence of human psychology in the marketing industry. In the third chapter, I attempt to connect the human emotions with economic decision-making. Here, the concept of emotional intelligence will help me to assert my standpoint. There is a study on some harmful emotions and their relationship with human judgment.

The main question of this thesis is whether emotions have a role in the economic decisions made by the individual. This topic is relevant because human beings are decision making bodies. Each decision has its own effect in the world. From the decision to take a step forward, to the decision to drop an atom bomb in a city, there are many instances through which humans make a significant impact in the world. Many people regret about their decisions later. Some decisions lack common sense and seems illogical. This often happens in the economical world. The possible ways to solve this crisis is to find the other factors which influence the decision making process. Emotions can be included as the main factor, which is responsible for both good decisions and the bad ones. In this paper, I look forward to bring some of the key emotional issues that are affecting the choices of the individuals and some possible ways to manage them to make stable decisions.

² Human behavior encompasses the human emotions.

Chapter-1

Relationship between Emotions and Ordinary Human Behavior

Introduction

We cannot get a complete understanding about the concept of emotions just by a descriptive illustration. Some philosophical insights would provide a clear outlook on the subject. An ordinary human being may encounter a bundle of emotions on a daily basis, such as getting amazed by seeing a beautiful picture or becoming angry at a bus driver who causes a traffic jam. Loss of a family member brings grief and sadness. In this chapter, there is a speculation about the meaning and significance of emotions.

1.1. Concept of Emotions

The term ‘emotion’ has originated from its etymological root word ‘emovere’ (Latin) which gives the meaning ‘to move out or agitate’. The fundamental aspect of every emotion is to initiate a driving force, which will affect our response to a given situation in a particular way.³ Here is a definition given by Plutchik (2001).

Emotion is a complex chain of loosely connected events that begins with a stimulus and includes feelings, psychological changes, impulses to action and specific goal directed behaviour”⁴. Robert C Solomon describes emotion as “a pre-conscious, pre-cognitive, more or less automatic excitation of an affect programme.”⁵

There has been a debate regarding the physical source of emotions. In the olden times, people attributed emotions to various parts of the body (head, heart, hands). Descartes found it difficult to deal with emotions since he assumed body and mind as separate substances. He then brought the place of connection (Pineal Gland) which connected the body and mind and indeed is the source of emotions.⁶ Based on the scientific studies, most of the emotional responses arise from the right hemisphere of

³Jan Slaby and Christian Von Scheve, *Affective Societies: Key Concepts* (New York: Routledge, 2019), 42. <https://philarchive.org/archive/SLAASK> (Accessed on 10-08-2024).

⁴Nitasha Singh Borah, et al., *Emotional Intelligence* (New Delhi: Indira Gandhi National Open University, 2020), 10.

⁵Robert C. Solomon, *Philosophy of Emotions*, ed. Anthony Hatzimoysis (New York: Cambridge University Press, 2003), 2.

⁶Robert Solomon, *Philosophy of Emotions* (n.p.: 2008), 6, <https://static1.squarespace.com/static/55917f64e4b0cd3b4705b68c/t/5bc7c26d085229afc6816a2e/1539818093990/solomon.2008.pdf> (accessed on February 8 2023)

the brain.⁷ William James and Carl Lange developed a theory and proposed that emotions are the result of the biochemical activities between the brain and the human body.⁸ There is a kind of stimulus and a response. To be more precise, there is an exchange of signals between the nerves basing on the stimulus and the brain gives command to various glands for secreting hormones. For example, the Amygdala has a role in the generation of the emotion like anger. There is a physical stimulus, which is transmitted to the brain via the senses and the Amygdala is activated. It produces hormones, which we experience as the increase in blood pressure, change in facial expression, aggression and so on.⁹

There are different functions of emotions namely intrinsic and extrinsic. The intrinsic function implies to the effect of emotion to the individual in the society. It focuses on the role of emotions within the body. They help the person to adapt to adverse conditions. For example, the emotion named fear produces hormones in the body (Adrenaline) which increases oxygen supply in vital parts of the body for facing impact. The extrinsic function involves the life where the person lives. Emotions help the person to live in the society in an effective way and coordinate among people.¹⁰ We can see people unite to protest or to celebrate basing on the emotions which they share in common. Some people who think alike or feel alike (kindred Spirits) gather together; for the better or the worse of the society.

To get more clarity about the concept of emotions, there is a need to distinguish between three terms mainly ‘emotions’, ‘feeling’ and ‘mood’. Feeling can be defined as “bodily felt component of an emotional episode”.¹¹ For example, our body starts shivering when we are undergoing a shocking or frightening experience. It could also be the flow of tears from the persons’ eyes while watching a very sad scene in the television. Moods can be described as general emotional experiences, which include both emotions and feelings; and it lasts for a long period. Moods do not require a particular stimulus to occur. They are caused by the after effects of a less stressful or

⁷Mathew Cobb, *The Idea of the Brain* (Great Britain: Profile Books, 2020), 347.

⁸Deepak Chopra and Rudolf E. Tanzi, *Super Genes* (United Kingdom: Penguin Random House, 2015), 94.

⁹ Robert Sapolsky, *Behave: The Biology of Humans at Our Best and Worst* (United Kingdom: Penguin Random House, 2018), 31.

¹⁰ Nitasha Singh Borah, *Emotional Intelligence*, 12.

¹¹Jan Slaby and Christian Von Scheve, *Affective Societies: Key Concepts*, 52.

more stressful emotional episode.¹² For example, if we are angry towards a person and the conflict is not solved, then there is a high probability of having a bad mood for the whole day. For some people, this may continue for a week. They differ from emotions as they lack an object to be directed at.¹³

1.2. A Cross-Cultural Study on the Philosophy of Emotions

It is evident that we can see the variability in the explanation of emotions across cultures but there are some common characteristics of emotions visible in every culture and that will be the part of this chapter. There are two ways in which emotions are observed. One is in the positive sense while the other is in the negative sense. Some philosophers hold on to the positive standpoint while others hold to the negative one and some accept both.

Aristotle, one of the ancient Greek philosophers tried to emphasize on the good side of emotions. In his *Rhetoric*, there is an explanation about the positive use of emotions for becoming a good orator. The speaker must be able to communicate his message in a lively manner so that the audience may understand it clearly. Emotions will help in achieving that task.¹⁴ He defines emotions “as that which leads one’s condition to become so transformed that his judgement is affected and which is accompanied by pleasure and pain. Examples of emotions include anger, fear, pity and the like, as well as the opposites of these”.¹⁵

Chinese philosophy looks at emotions as something to be controlled or regulated which holds the negative standpoint. Here is an excerpt of the Chinese philosopher QiSong about emotions:

Some sages fearing that the coherence principle in heaven may be destroyed and that social relations may fall into confusion, created ritual behaviour, music, laws and political administration in order to regulate people’s feelings and emotions of happiness, anger, grief, fear, love and hate as well as [these] dependances and decrees; in order to guide to behave according to humanness, appropriate behaviour, wisdom and fidelity to one’s pledged word, the sages developed the content of divine teaching.¹⁶

¹²Nitasha Singh Borah, *Emotional Intelligence*, 11.

¹³Dilip Roy, “Emotion and Moods,” *International Journal of Management and Commerce Innovations* . 8, no.2 (October 2020), 49.

¹⁴Lane Cooper, *The Rhetoric of Aristotle* (New York: Appleton Century Crofts, 1932), 91.

¹⁵Robert Solomon, *Philosophy of Emotions*. (n.p.: 2008), 5.

¹⁶Diana Arghirescu, “Spiritual Discipline, Emotions and Behaviour During the Song Dynasty: Zhu Xi’s and Qi Song Dynasty: Zhu Xi’s and Qi Song’s Commentaries on the ZhongYong in Comparative Perspective,” *Philosophy East and West* 70, no.1 (January 2020), 10.

Indian philosophy accepts both positive and negative sides of emotions. In the Ancient Indian texts (Vedas), we can see the negative side of emotions. The Vedanta considers emotions as block or hindrance for attaining the liberation of the body. While yoga refers to it as the fluctuations of the mind. The body needs to be controlled and the emotions are to be regulated. Ayurveda distinguishes emotions as both positive and negative. The negative emotions lead to sickness while the positive emotions help to cure it. When we examine the developments in modern India, there is a strict opposition to the traditional laws and sacrificial aspects of religion. People started to focus on the devotional aspects of religion. The Bhakti movements lead to the shift in considering emotions as something positive which helps the devotee in reaching a state of oneness with God.¹⁷

There existed a traditional concept that focused on the power of reason to control the passions. The medieval philosophy dominated by Christian dogmatism stood for that viewpoint. Emotional control is required for reaching sanctity. Here is an excerpt:

And so, the Christian preoccupation with sin led to elaborate analyses of those emotions, passions, and desires designated as sins (notably greed, gluttony, lust, anger, envy, and pride; sloth, perhaps, is a special case). The tight linkage between the study of emotion and ethics is particularly evident in the curious observation that the highest virtues, such as love, hope, and faith, were not classified as emotions as such, but were rather elevated to a higher status and often (e.g., by Thomas Aquinas) equated with reason. The old master–slave metaphor remained alive and well, and as some emotions were seen as sins, the highest virtues could hardly be counted among the mere emotions.¹⁸

Thomas Hobbes had a difference of opinion. He considered emotions as something positive and advantageous. They help in the survival of the humankind. Without instincts, drives and emotions, it would have been difficult for man to survive. According to him, all the negative aspects of emotions are due to the thirst for dominance which humans' desire above other beings. They want power and have no intention in causing harm or violence.¹⁹ Nietzsche criticizes the church by saying "to attack the passions at their roots means to attack life at its roots".²⁰ He brought out a different perspective on the aspect of emotions and seeing them as something advantageous, which could be used for the benefit of humankind.

¹⁷June McDaniel, *Emotions in Asian Thought*, ed. Joel Marks and Roger T. Ames, (New Delhi: Sri Satguru, 1997) 40.

¹⁸Robert Solomon, *Philosophy of Emotions*, 9.

¹⁹Richard Tuck, *Hobbes: A Very Short Introduction* (New York: Oxford University, 1989), 65.

²⁰June McDaniel, *Emotions in Asian Thought*, 215.

“Nietzsche gives the emotions and passions an unprecedentedly important role, seeing them as providing ways to a more fulfilling existence as well as to various truths concerning the human condition. Instead of pitting the intellect against the emotions, he encourages the cultivation of a passion for knowledge and understanding”²¹.

In the western philosophical systems, the concept of emotions has been attributed as a ‘disruption and a naive aspect’ of a human being. When we take decisions based on illogical circumstances, we often hear the comment: ‘Don’t get emotional’. Thus, many philosophers desired to create a pure reason without the role of emotions. There are also different perspectives in which we connect these categories.²² David Hume supported the dominance of the passions over reason and the influence of emotions in rational thinking. Hegel emphasized on the positive side of emotions. He further explains that emotions are pivotal in attaining any achievement²³. The relationship between emotions and reasoning is indeed evident just as Robert C Solomon describes, “Emotions are not disruptions of our otherwise calm and reasonable experience; they are at the very heart of that experience, determining our focus, influencing our interests, defining the dimensions of the world”²⁴.

The separation of reason and emotions will never give us a true understanding about how the human cognition operates. Holding on to any one of these categories will lead us to meaningless conclusions. “The failure to develop the emotional life will lead to abstraction and division, in a failure to see life steadily and as a whole”.²⁵

1.3. Theories on Emotions

A lot of research has taken place in the past two centuries on studying the development of emotions in the human body. There are namely three prominent theories, which will give light on the speculation of emotions. Moreover, they are James-Lange Theory, Cannon-Bard Theory and Cognitive Theory.

²¹ June McDaniel, *Emotions in Asian Thought*, 214.

²² By categories I imply Reason and Emotion.

²³ Robert C. Solomon, “Some Notes on Emotion”, *Philosophy East and West* 45, No.2 (April 1995), 173.

²⁴ *Ibid*, 177.

²⁵ John Mac Murray. *Reason and Emotion*, (Great Britain: Faber and Faber, 1972), 77.

1.3.1. James-Lange Theory

William James and Carl Lange proposed this theory. They argued that emotions occur after some physiological changes in the body²⁶. To be more precise, they supported the body-brain connection for the formation of emotions. Here is an excerpt from James:

Common sense says, we lose our fortune, are sorry and weep; we meet a bear, are frightened and run; we are insulted by a rival, are angry and strike. The hypothesis here to be defended says that this order of sequence is incorrect.... And that the more rational statement is that we feel sorry because we strike, afraid because we tremble...²⁷

The understanding of emotions is mainly based on the responses of the body. “An emotion was not a direct reaction to some environmental event, but rather a reaction to how the body was responding to that environmental event”²⁸.

1.3.2. Cannon-Bard Theory

Walter B. Cannon (1927), a psychologist from Harvard University had a difference in opinion regarding the James-Lange Theory. He along with Philip Bard, proposed a thalamic theory of emotion. They argued that the emotion is experienced as the function of the thalamus and the emotional response, which includes physical changes; comes as a function of the hypothalamus. However, they concluded that the emotion is experienced first, which is followed by behavioral changes²⁹. In general, they concluded, “emotion precedes overt behavior and consists mainly of a general state of arousal or activation”³⁰.

1.3.3. Cognitive Theory of Emotion

Psychologists namely Stanley Schachter and Jerome Singer proposed this theory. Schachter commented, “What people experience as emotion is based on a combination of physiological arousal and information that leads them to interpret the arousal as a particular type of emotion”.³¹ Through many scientific research methods,

²⁶ Arno f. Wittig and Gurney Williams, *Psychology: An Introduction*, (Singapore: McGraw-Hill Books, 1984), 415.

²⁷ Ibid, 415.

²⁸ Charles F. Levinthal, *Introduction to Physiological Psychology*, 3rd ed., (New Delhi: Prentice Hall of India, 2005), 354.

²⁹ Clifford T. Morgan, *Physiological Psychology*, 3rd ed. (Tokyo: McGraw Hill, 1965), 310.

³⁰ Lyle E. Bourne and Bruce R. Ekstrand, *Psychology*, 4th ed., (New York: CBS College, 1982), 262.

³¹ Robert A. Baron, Donn Byrne and Barry H. Kantowitz, *Psychology: Understanding Behavior*, 2nd ed., (United States of America: Holf Rinehart and Winston, 1980), 346.

they assert their standpoint. When it comes to recognizing our emotions, we need information about how we are feeling. Nisbett and Schachter conducted an experiment and came into a conclusion that when we are more informed about our bodily reactions, we feel them in a more intense way.³² However, there are chances when we misinterpret emotions in the presence of wrong information.

Conclusion

Emotions are indeed relevant and inseparable from the life of an ordinary person. The description of emotions cannot be studied evidently without a philosophical background. A speculation into the world philosophies regarding emotions give us a clear idea about it. The early mythological preconceptions about the source of emotions made a confusion regarding the understanding about emotions. Emotions are pre-conscious and pre-cognitive as Robert C Solomon asserted. I hold on to a standpoint that emotions and the behavioral responses³³ occur together at the same time. The external changes can differ from person to person because the individual has the freedom to choose whether or not to express them. They are part of the human identity. Emotions are positive and negative according to their effective management by the individual. There is always a tendency to hold on some positive emotions like happiness and surprise and neglect the negatives like fear and anger. The negative emotions are not a liability but a means for survival and should be respected. For example, if we don't have the emotion of fear there would be no adherence to moral laws and we will end up in total disruption and chaos.

³² Norman L. Mun, *Introduction to Psychology*, 3rd ed. (Boston: Houghton and Mifflin Company, 1976), 411.

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Chapter-2

Decision Making in the Background of Behavioral Economics

Introduction

To get a deeper insight about the role of emotions in the economic decision-making, the study of Behavioral Economics (BE) would be very useful. It looks into the millions of decisions we make on our day-to-day activities. The enquiry has more scientific backup, which allows going beyond the linear probabilistic and theoretical ways of economic calculations and including behavioral insights to the data. This gives a holistic notion about the reality. Here is a simple definition: “Behavioral economics is about applying insights from laboratory experiments, psychology and other social studies in economics”³⁴. It provides a clear framework about the economic behavior of the individuals and gives the pros and cons of the involvement of emotions in human decision-making.

2.1. Economic behaviorism: Producing Better Decisions in Economic Analysis

Behavioral Economics is a field, which combines both psychology and economics. Economics developed way before psychology. Adam Smith (1759), the proponent of classical economics has mentioned in his work ‘The Theory of Moral Sentiments’ about the connection of human behavior and economics. Jeremy Bentham (proponent of the Utilitarian theory) who brought out the principles to form neo-classical economics has stated the inevitable relationship of the human psyche and the rate of utility³⁵.

In the twentieth century, we can see that there is a shift; which includes the separation of psychological aspects from economics so that economics can be an independent discipline like natural science. Vilfredo Pareto (1897) was the initiator for

³⁴Edward Cartwright, *Behavioral Economics* (New York: Routledge, 2011), 4. <https://thuvienso.hoasen.edu.vn/bitstream/handle/123456789/13117/Contents.pdf?sequence=1> (Accessed on 22-07-2024).

³⁵Colin F. Camerer, George Loewenstein and Mathew Robin eds., *Advances in Behavioral Economics* (New Jersey: Princeton University Press, 2004), 5. https://books.google.co.in/books?hl=en&lr=&id=xWKYDwAAQBAJ&oi=fnd&pg=PR11&dq=+Advances+in+Behavioral+Economics+&ots=midFHPfU1s&sig=H6yH54RqkUSOIVEyih5ZNyQxt0A&redir_esc=y#v=onepage&q=Advances%20in%20Behavioral%20Economics&f=false (Accessed on 26-07-2024).

this revolution. He argued that the economy of a country in the idealistic terms will not have any psychological influence. He emphasized that the two fields will discuss about two issues. Economics will deal with more of choices while psychology's focus would be on desire. Economics will make conclusions on what we do and psychology enquires about why we do it³⁶.

The rise of behaviorism had a huge impact on the field of economics. John Broadus Watson brought up behaviorism in the early twentieth century. He proposed a theory, which included the study of behavior in a more observational and naturalistic way, which will give light to the complex problems of mental understanding³⁷. The advances in animal psychology by Thorndike and Pavlov also helped to improve the Watson theory. B.F Skinner provided a more convincing standpoint on the subject matter. He argued that the theories of studying the human behavior just by hypothetical and less factual explanations would lead us nowhere. "I look forward to an overall theory of human behavior which will bring together a lot of facts and express them in a more general way"³⁸. Skinner also concluded that by studying behavior in a more empirical way; there are means to control or regulate it. So, it can be used for the benefit of the society³⁹. This revolution had a great impact on the field of economics. Earlier, economics used the probabilistic theories for having optimal management and now it is using behavioral theories to correct and improve its challenges.

When the findings of cognitive psychology and brain science developed, there emerged a new field called economic behaviorism. Psychologists namely Daniel Kahneman and Amos Tversky (1970) wrote many contributions to this area of study. After further research by them joined by Richard Thaler; Behavioral Economics was considered as a full-fledged discipline⁴⁰. Here are some insights by Richard Thaler:

There is nothing unique about incorporating psychological factors such as framing, self-control and fairness into economic analyses. If such factors help us understand the world better and improve predictions about behavior, then

³⁶ Edward Cartwright, *Behavioral Economics*, 5.

³⁷ Edna Heidbreder, *Seven Psychologies* (New Jersey: Prentice-Hall, 1961), 235.

³⁸ Larry A. Hjelle and Daniel Ziegler, *Personality Theories: Basic Assumption, Research and Applications*, 2nd ed., (np.: McGraw Hill, 1981), 193.

³⁹ Calvin S. Hall and Gardiner Lindzey, *Theories of Personality*, 2nd ed., (n.p: John Wiley and Sons, 1970), 482.

⁴⁰ Christian Brendt, university of Zurich, *BE and Development Policy*, (n.p.:n.d.), 2. https://www.researchgate.net/profile/Christian-Berndt-2/publication/334989272_Behavioral_economics_and_development_policy/links/5d4953c7299bf1995b6983ee/Behavioral-economics-and-development-policy.pdf (Accessed 10-08-2024).

why wouldn't we use them just like we use any other new source of data such as web searches or genetic markers.⁴¹

Richard Thaler and Daniel Kahneman received the Nobel Prize for their immense contribution in the field of Behavioral Economics. When we have good understanding about the economic behavior, we will be able to make better decisions.

2.2. Decision Making Process

Decisions are the fundamental aspect of our lives. We undergo more than a hundred occasions in a daily basis where decisions are made. In this chapter, there is an outlook on the whole process of decision making. It can be described as:

the study of identifying and choosing alternatives bound on values and preferences of the decision maker. Making a decision implies that there are alternative choices to be considered and in such a case we want not only to identify as many of these alternatives as possible but to choose the one that best fits with our goals, objectives, desires, values and so on.⁴²

Sometimes, the life situations pose an uncertainty and confusion. This is called as a mystery dimension. To solve this mystery; one must have an ardent desire to reach the truth through lot of enquiries⁴³. The quest should be an authentic approach with the use of human faculties for a better life.

There is a discussion based on the role of free will and determinism in the role of making decisions. Here is Henri Bergson's analysis of determinism in comparison to freedom in decision-making:

Within our ego's linear perspective, a decision is seen in special terms, ego is located between two [or more] choice parts. Shall ego decide to take route A or route B? determinism argues that the choice can be predicted prior to the action, given our knowledge of the variables that influence human behavior. The free will position that we can never know the choice in advance for if ego chooses A, he can always say realistically that he could have done otherwise and chosen B.⁴⁴

⁴¹ Richard Thaler, Behavioral Economics Past, Present and Future, *The American Economical Review* 106 No: 7 (n.p.: July 2016), 1597. https://paulgp.github.io/speeches/thaler_2016_aea.pdf (Accessed on July 2024).

⁴²James Falop, *Introduction to Decision Making Methods* (Hungarian Academy of Sciences:n.d), 1. <https://d1wqtxts1xzle7.cloudfront.net/43447287/decisionmakingmethods-libre.pdf> (Accessed on 10-07-2024).

⁴³ Paul C. Nutt and David C. Wilson eds., *The Political Aspects of Strategic Decisions, Handbook of Decision Making* (United Kingdom: John Wiley and Sons, 2010) 191. <https://d1wqtxts1xzle7.cloudfront.net/74217658/file1-libre.pdf> (Accessed on13-07-2024).

⁴⁴ Edward E. Sampson, *Ego at the Threshold* (New York: Dell Publishing, 1975), 138.

In this chapter, there will be an analysis on the two angles in making decisions on the background of Behavioral Economics and they are Economic and Biological perspectives respectively.

2.2.1. Economical Perspective

Economics is a field of study, which focuses on management of resources in a conservative manner. We deal with money, labour, capital and many other assets. The process of management involves crucial decisions. Those decisions are the result of analysis and synthesis of various information. The process of mathematical structuring and probability play an important role because decision-making involves foreseeing the future. We make decisions based on calculations and hypotheses. All these calculations emerge from information, which we have, and then we reach a conclusion⁴⁵.

Stankovich and West (2000) made research regarding economical decisions and they differentiated the decision making into two; mainly the Intuitive System (System 1) and Reasoning (System 2). The distinction is based on cognitive functioning. System 1 is acting as a rapid decision-making system, which is more automatic, and the emotions can influence them. System 2 is comparatively slower and analytical and sometimes the stressful type⁴⁶. There are situations where both systems switch each other. For example, Bazerman, Loewenstein and White (1992) observed the response of people towards multiple choices. They found out that when people had multiple choices in front of them, they had more will power to make decisions than the situation where they had to accept or reject the options individually. At the beginning; the individuals use system 1, which is sub optimal, but later they switch on to System 2⁴⁷.

Economic models based on both cognitive science and heuristic principles⁴⁸ provide a better framework to make decisions without error. Let us take the example of the decisions taken by the government and local based authorities regarding the conservation of natural resources and the ecosystem. Generally, most of the decisions

⁴⁵ Brian Christian and Tom Griffiths, *Algorithms to Live By*, (London: William Collins, 2017), 151.

⁴⁶ Katherine L. Milkman, Dolly Chug and Max H. Bazerman, *How can Decision Making can be Improved* (n.p:n.d, 2008), 4. <https://repository.upenn.edu/server/api/core/bitstreams/cc2b4bc1-b2d7-48ec-8064-67d4df49765e/content> (Accessed on 13-08-2024).

⁴⁷ Katherine L. Milkman, Dolly Chug and Max H. Bazerman, *How can Decision Making can be Improved*, 7.

⁴⁸ Heuristic principles are cognitive shortcuts or rules of thumb that consumers use to make quick efficient decisions about products and services.

rely on economic values, which are obtained by sufficient analysis. Therefore, the government gets a real picture of what is happening there⁴⁹. There is also a field called Neuroeconomics, which looks into the value-based decisions that people take and the mechanism of the body⁵⁰.

2.2.2. Biological Perspective

The aspect of making choices should also be analyzed as from inside the human body. This includes a speculation into the biology and neuroscience of human beings. The advancements of science and technology, has contributed for getting a good understanding of what is happening within ourselves.

In the late 1970s and 80s there was a lot of research about human cognition and rational capacity. Psychology flourished as an independent discipline. Until then, there was a trend to explain the field of economics independent of the mind, structuring it only based on mathematical equations and heuristic principles. Daniel Kahneman and Amos Tversky (1979) did research on the decision-making process of individuals. They noted different cases, which involved biases and were against the calculations of the principles of making decisions. By the end of the research, they concluded that there are psychological factors like emotions, which influence decision-making⁵¹.

There are various areas of the brain functioning in a synchronized way during the decision-making process. The Prefrontal Cortex plays an essential role. This region becomes activated when we take decisions (Value based) regarding sustainable human relationships. It also functions as a regulatory role to control the emotional responses,

⁴⁹ Jan J. Bateman et al., Bringing Ecosystem Services into Economic-Decision Making: Land Use in the United Kingdom, *Science* (n.p.: n.d.), 1. <https://ir.cwi.nl/pub/8233/8233D.pdf><https://ore.exeter.ac.uk/repository/bitstream/handle/10871/19382/Bateman%20et%20al%202013%20NEA%20submitted%20Science.pdf?sequence=1> (Accessed on August 2024)

⁵⁰ George Lazarolu et al, "Can Neuroscience Assist Us in Constructing Better Patterns of Economic-Decision Making," *Frontiers in Behavioral Neuroscience*, Vol 11, No:188, 1. <https://www.frontiersin.org/journals/behavioral-neuroscience/articles/10.3389/fnbeh.2017.00188/full> (Accessed on 10-08-2024).

⁵¹ Nazir Naqvi, Baba Shiv and Antoine Bechara, "The Role of Emotion in Decision- Making: A Cognitive Neuroscience Perspective," Vol 15, No 5. *Current Directions in Psychological Science* (n.p.: December 2016), 260. <https://scalar.usc.edu/works/moral-decision-making-in-autism-spectrum-disorder/media/Current%20Directions%20in%20Psychological%20Science-2006-Naqvi-260-4.pdf> (Accessed on 13-07-2024).

which could break down the relationships⁵². Scientists also found out that any damage to the ventromedial frontal cortex could disrupt decision making in the person⁵³.

In a psychological perspective, the process of decision-making can be understood in a clearer way. Each choice we make has a relationship with us and the people around us. It is connected to the self and the world⁵⁴. Every decision has its own consequences. What we decide to do and not to do, has a lot of influence in this world. Humans just cannot neglect the fact of making decisions; almost every moment.

In this research paper, I would like to hold on a middle position that both of these factors (Economical and Biological perspectives) are evident and well present while making decisions and judgment. These factors give a holistic understanding about decision making process. The economical perspective provides a theoretical framework and the biological perspective looks into some empirical evidence for it. For example, the emotion called fear is regulated by a hormone called Serotonin (5 hydroxytryptamine). Serotonin has an influence in the decision-making faculty.⁵⁵ A theory based on the relationship between fear and decision making can be made by economic analyses and also with biological evidences. So, a theory or model made with both perspectives will have a completeness.

2.3. Consumer Behavior

In the framework of Behavioral Economics, there is a requirement to look into the consumption and production of resources in which we are involved. The marketing sector, industrial sector, the food sector and so on. India is one of the biggest consumers of various resources and because of its humungous population, lot of multinational companies are in a favorable position to have a good business partnership with India. There is also a critical remark that India is becoming more consumeristic than productive or being more innovative. Here in this chapter, there is an outlook on the

⁵² James K. Rilling and Alan Sanfey, The Neuroscience of Social Decision Making, *Annual Review: Psychology*, (n.p.: september 2010) , 39.
<https://repository.ubn.ru.nl/bitstream/handle/2066/99774/99774.pdf?sequence=1> (Accessed on 25-07-2024).

⁵³ Lesley K. Fellows, The Cognitive Neuroscience of Human Decision Making: A Review and a Conceptual Framework, *Behavioral and Cognitive Neuroscience Review* 2004, No 3, 159.
<https://core.ac.uk/download/pdf/194273627.pdf> (Accessed on 20-09-2024).

⁵⁴ Daniel T Levinson, *The seasons of Man's Life* (New York: Ballantine Books, March 1979), 49.

⁵⁵ Reference from footnote number 83.

modes of behavior of the consumers, which influence their choices, and strategies of various marketing industries, which affect them. Consumer behavior can be broadly defined as the “acquisition, consumption and disposition of products, services time and ideas by decision making units. (Jacoby 1975, 1976)”⁵⁶.

There are various factors, which affect consumer behavior in context of marketing and purchase. They are mainly social, cultural, personal, and psychological. Firstly, the social factors include family, class, and status. Cultural factors include the buyer culture, sub culture⁵⁷, and social class. The psychological factors include motivation perception and the attitudes of the person. Personal factors comprise of age, occupation, economic situation, and life style of the individual.⁵⁸

Here, I would like to examine on the psychological factor in detail. They are internal mental processes that guides the consumer to make decisions. Motivation is the first psychological factor and it implies the strong need of the individuals within themselves. They desire for something or the other, those needs could be related to the body or could be the influence of the external world and so on. The person can be aware or not aware of these needs. The marketing experts analyze the need of the individual, relates it with the product to be sold, and persuades the consumer in various ways to buy the product. So, the need changes into a motive when the consumer feels satisfied with the product and feels that his unmet need is fulfilled. When we come to perception (second factor), it is the trump card of the marketing strategy. Perception is a way of creating and presenting information in a very convincing way so that the consumer will be tempted to buy the product. Most often, consumers are deceived through the attractive presentation and the seductive advertisements of different products. The third psychological factor is termed as belief and practice. By expert marketing of special brands, the customer has a belief system, which is developed by the sellers. Many

⁵⁶ Shannon Cummins and James W. Peltier, “Consumer Behavior in the Online Context,” *Journal of Research in Interactive Marketing* Vol: 8, No: 3 (n.p.: Emerald Group, 2014), 184. https://www.researchgate.net/profile/ShannonCummins/publication/265969362_Consumer_behavior_in_the_online_context/links/565f39a608aeafc2aaca3b82/Consumer-behavior-in-the-online-context.pdf?origin=journalDetail&_tp=eyJwYWdlIjoiam91cm5hbERldGFpbCJ9 (Accessed on August 2024).

⁵⁷ A sub culture is a group of people who share a set of secondary values. People of a sub culture will be part of a larger culture but share a specific identity within a smaller group.

⁵⁸ Nitesh B. Gajjar, “Factors Affecting Consumer Behavior,” *Online international reviewed monthly journal*, Vol 1, Issue 3, (n.p.:April 2013), 10-14. https://www.raijmr.com/ijrhs/wp-content/uploads/2017/11/IJRHS_2013_vol01_issue_02_02.pdf (Accessed on 13-08-2024).

brands are blindly believed to be the best. That itself attracts more consumers. Many brands promoting advertisements and methods are used to sustain the belief system.

Consumer decisions are closely related with emotions. In the consumer world, we have emotions clubbed in the term called 'Affect'. It includes all the personal experiences and feelings of the individual and moods too.⁵⁹ The businesspersons use many methods to stir up the emotions in the person. In this advanced age, we can observe that the advertisements are becoming more and more persuasive for the consumers because of the emotional content in them. System 1 decision making operation takes place at this time⁶⁰ which is more or less automatic. Sometimes the buyers give huge amount of money to buy their commodities. An amount, which might even seem irrational as compared to the worth of the product. Most of the big companies look forward for advertising through online means because the modern society spends most of their time in social media. "Online brand communities are effective consumer tools for both experienced and novice customers".⁶¹

When it comes to lure consumers, the marketing experts analyze the kind of ritual behavior, which is trending in the society. This is somewhat similar to mob psychology (the mob has no individual motive but like to choose whatever the crowd chooses). The crowd always follows a mythical and ritual pattern following some kind of imaginary concepts⁶². it could be like following the life of a celebrity. The products promoted by them are simply promoted by the fans; without checking on the authenticity of the product.

⁵⁹ Joel B. Cohen, Michel Juan Tuan Pham and Eduardo B. Andrado, "The Role of Nature and Affect in Consumer Behaviour," *Handbook of Consumer Psychology*, (n.p: University of Florida, June 2006), 3.
https://d1wqtxts1xzle7.cloudfront.net/46414133/The_Nature_and_Role_of_Affect_in_Consume20160612-6046-18k1djd-libre.pdf (Accessed on 02-09-2024).

⁶⁰ Refer Chapter 2, Decision Making: Economical Model.

⁶¹ Shannon Cummins and James W. Peltier, "Consumer Behavior in the Online Context," 184.
https://www.researchgate.net/profile/Shannon-Cummins/publication/265969362_Consumer_behavior_in_the_online_context/links/565f39a608aeafc2aaca3b82/Consumer-behavior-in-the-online-context.pdf (Accessed on 10-08-2024).

⁶² Dennis Wrook, "Ritual Dimension of Consumer Behavior," *The Journal of Consumer Research* Vol 12, No 3 (n.p.:University of Chicago press, December 1985), 262.
https://d1wqtxts1xzle7.cloudfront.net/67402817/f554282688e8f9800a66821ae90662970aac-libre.pdf?1621736749=&response-content-disposition=inline%3B+filename%3Dthe_Ritual_Dimension_of_Consumer_Behavio.pdf (Accessed on August 2024).

There is also a link between time and consumer behavior. The product advertising methods including flash sales with a time limit. Less time implies less thinking period. Customers who are in this condition focus of negative product information than the positives. “So eventually they [Customers] end up buying the products with only positives. In the reduction of time people have a tendency to think with limited amount of logical sense”.⁶³

2.4. Harmful Emotions which Disrupt Decision Making

In this chapter, there will be an inquiry into the important emotions which influence our judgement and choice.

Emotions not only can arise from but also give rise to an implicit cognitive predisposition to appraise future events in line with an “appraisal tendency”, or a goal-directed process through which an emotion affects judgement and choice until the emotion eliciting problem is solved. Although such appraisals are tailored to help a person respond to the event evoked the emotion, they persist beyond the eliciting situation, becoming an unconscious perceptual lens for interpreting subsequent judgement and choices.⁶⁴

Judgement and the emotional stability are interrelated. Our mind has to be emotionally sound for going through a decision-making process. If this is not the case, then there will be biases in the decisions we make.

2.4.1. Anger

Anger can be described as “an immediate response to unjustified harm which someone has inflicted upon us, or related to us”.⁶⁵ The main cause for anger is an undeserved offense, which is made against us. If we deserve the offense is unjust, then there is a response of anger in ourselves. There are many causes for anger. It could be not only

⁶³Jacob Jacoby, George J. Szybillo and Carol Kohn Berning. Time and consumer behavior: An interdisciplinary Overview, *Journal of Consumer Research* Vol:2 No:4 (n.p: University of Chicago press, March 1976), 331. https://www.researchgate.net/profile/Jacob-Jacoby/publication/24098804_Time_and_Consumer_Behavior_An_Interdisciplinary_Overview/links/53d67bbd0cf220632f3da370/Time-and-Consumer-Behavior-An-Interdisciplinary-Overview.pdf (Accessed on 30-08-2024).

⁶⁴ Jennifer S. Lenner, Larissa Z. Tiedens. Portrait of the angry decision maker: How appraisal tendencies shape anger’s influence on cognition, *Journal of Behavioral Decision Making* Vol:19 (n.p.: , 2006),118. <https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/pdf/10.1002/bdm.515> (Accessed on 08-09-2024).

⁶⁵ John Antony, *Emotions in Counselling*, 224.

the influence of persons but also the objects related to the subject and also bodily concerns like fatigue and irritation.⁶⁶

Aristotle, one of the most prominent ancient Greek philosophers; had studied anger. He foretold that there are relations between anger and judgment of the person.⁶⁷ Later, scientists, through their experiments found out that angry people were backward in solving ethical problems and their decision making was illegitimate involving trickery and deception⁶⁸. It was also observed that angry individuals are more goal oriented. They make choices which are related to their goal.⁶⁹ Therefore, this makes them vulnerable. They fail to check on better options or the ones that produce optimal result.

2.4.2. Fear

Fear can be understood as “an emotional state, a psychological and a psychophysiological response to perceived or anticipated threats or danger.”⁷⁰ The aftereffects could include bodily responses like shivering and mild paralysis. Extreme fear can cause severe bodily problems. Researchers namely Bouffard Exum and Paternoster found out that fear has an impact in the decision making process. There is a tendency within the individuals to focus on certain aspects of the decision while immersed with the emotion (fear).⁷¹ The person will have only limited attention towards all the consequences of the decision. In short, there will not be a clear understanding

⁶⁶ Ibid, 223.

⁶⁷ Jennifer S. Lenner, *Portrait of the angry decision maker: how appraisal tendencies shape anger's influence on cognition*, 115.

⁶⁸ Chase E Thiel, Shane Connely and Jennifer A. Griffith, The Influence of Anger on ethical Decision Making: comparison of primary and secondary appraisal. *Ethics and Behavior* Vol 2, No; 5. (Taylor and Francis group), 381. https://d1wqtxts1xzle7.cloudfront.net/42075815/The_Influence_of_Anger_on_Ethical_Decisi20160204-10910-1dxiyy2-libre.pdf (Accessed on 08-07-2024).

⁶⁹ Uzma Khan, Alexander Depaoli and Michal Maimaran, Unique Role of Anger among negative emotions in goal directed decision making, *JACR* Vol 4 No 1,(n.p: Chicago Press, Nov 2018), 67. <https://www.kellogg.northwestern.edu/faculty/maimaran/personal/Papers/JACR.2.pdf> (Accessed on 08-07-2024).

⁷⁰ Elsa Ronningston and Arielle R. Baskin Soumers, *Fear and Decision making in narcissistic personality disorder: A link between psycho analysis and neuroscience* (n.p.: Taylor and Francis Group, April 2022), 192. <https://www.tandfonline.com/doi/pdf/10.31887/DCNS.2013.15.2/eronningstan> (Accessed on 08-07-2024).

⁷¹ Oliver chand and Graciela chichilisky, The influence of fear in decisions: Experimental Evidence , *Journal of risk and uncertainty* Vol 39 No:3 (n.p.: Columbia University, December 2004), 3. https://chichilnisky.com/pdfs/Chanel_Chichilnisky_Influence_of_fear_in_decision_Definitive%20FINAL.pdf (Accessed on 08-07-2024).

within the person. There will be an element of logical inconsistency within the individual while judgement. During a difficult situation like an earthquake or landslide, many people lose their lives even after provided with adequate safety precautions.

Fear has a great influence in marketing and financial sector. “due to fear investors always approach certain [sure] events and stay away from uncertain and risky events and at the time of decision making, anxious investors prefer a certain event”⁷². When it comes to make profit, there is a requirement to think in a creative way. Sometimes, this may include the initiative to take risk. Fearful people cannot do that. Moreover, risks taken in the financial sector are mostly calculated risks. There are strategical experts who can predict the difficulties of the stock market by mathematical calculations and experience. So, a novice observer might find absurdity in those risks.

Biologically speaking, the fear is regulated by a hormone called Serotonin (5 hydroxytryptamine). Serotonin has an influence in the decision-making faculty too.⁷³ This can give a simple conclusion that there is an inseparable link between fear and decision-making. When we are faced with choices, our tendency always goes for the best option. At the same time, there is a fear inside us, which fills us with anxiety.

Conclusion

Behavioral Economics is a relatively new field, which holds out many opportunities in the scientific world. Many developments have been brought out by this field. In the case of decision-making Behavioral Economics gives a clear insight about what really happens in our cognition and judgment. The Economical and Biological perspectives of the decision-making process vividly illustrates the two angles of choice making. The consumer behavior was speculated to get an understanding about the subject matter in a better way. There are influence of some negative emotions like anger and fear which tamper decision making. The decision making of the individual can be

⁷² Ebin Ul Hassan, Impact of affect Heuristic Fear and anger on the decision amking of an individual investor: a conceptual study, *World Applied Sciences Journal* Vol 23 No:4.(n.p.: dosi publications, June 2013),510. <https://d1wqtxts1xzle7.cloudfront.net/88240997/11-libre.pdf> (Accessed on 08-07-2024).

⁷³ Livin C. Crison et al, genetic contributions of Serotonin transporter to social learning of fear and economic decision making, *Scan* (n.p.: , january 2009), 399. <https://watermark.silverchair.com/nsp019.pdf> (Accessed on 08-07-2024).

biased at some times because of the varying emotional states and there is a need to tackle the problems caused by negative emotions.

Chapter 3

Human Emotions in Economic Behavior

Introduction

What a foe may do to a foe
Or a hater to a hater
Far worse than that
The mind ill held may do to him
No mother, father, nor even other kinsmen
May do that good to him
Far better than that
The mind well held may do to him

The Dhammapada (1987)⁷⁴

In this thesis, the main aim would be the application of knowledge obtained from the previous two chapters. The skill of managing one's mental life has a great role in forming a good society. Just managing them is not enough. The individual has to find out different alternatives to use these emotions for a better life. The arm chair speculations of rational theories regarding economic behavior are incomplete. By the arrival of Behavioral Economics, economic behavior can be understood more clearly connecting it with psychology. Since decision making is an important aspect to be improved, I have included the aspect of emotional intelligence and economic decisions which helps in framing better decisions.

3.1. Some Basic Economic Behaviors

Here I would like to highlight some of the basic economic behaviors and they are as follows:

⁷⁴Kishore Chandiramani, *Emotions and Stress: How to Manage Them* (India: Patridge, 2016), 36.
https://books.google.co.in/books?hl=en&lr=&id=2HNsDAAAQBAJ&oi=fnd&pg=PT4&dq=,+Emotions+and+Stress:+How+to+Manage+Them+&ots=UygpJkIOQA&sig=5sJJKWkrSfp4fEEQzPdpwO1Vxc0&redir_esc=y#v=onepage&q=%2C%20Emotions%20and%20Stress%3A%20How%20to%20Manage%20Them&f=false (Accessed on 10-09-2024).

3.1.1. Emotion Work

Emotion work can be understood as the mental work which includes the understanding and feeling with the moods of others to make them satisfied and happy. This is a kind of empathizing with others. A suitable example is the role of air hostesses to manage the passengers who are in discomfort.⁷⁵ In the service sector especially in call centers, a lot of emotion work is done. Those people are paid to keep the consumers happy.

3.1.2 Emotional Action

These are the deeds of a person which arises due to the particular emotional state the individual is. Max Weber mentions about emotional action in bureaucratic institutions.⁷⁶ For example, if the person's emotional state is extreme anger, the emotional action will include aggressive behavior of inflicting verbal or physical abuse on associates or subordinates.

3.1.3. Emotional Contagion

Emotional Contagion can be defined as "A mechanism through which feelings are transferred in a seemingly automatic way from one person to another".⁷⁷ It is the skill through which the speaker gains control over the listener's emotions through words. For example, Steve Jobs⁷⁸ had the skill of manipulating the people through his 'reality distortion field'.⁷⁹ He was able to take the client's emotion through his convincing speech and behavior.⁸⁰

3.2. Emotions which Affect Economic Behavior

There are various emotions which affect the economic behavior and I have enlisted a few of them namely happiness, guilt and envy.

⁷⁵ Michael Haralambos, *Sociology: Themes and Perspectives*, 5th ed., (London: Harper Collins, 2000), 516.

⁷⁶ Bureaucracy is an organization with a hierarchy of paid, full time officials with who form a chain of command.

⁷⁷ Robert Baron, *Social Psychology* 10th ed., (New Delhi: Prentice Hall, 2011), 40.

⁷⁸ The founder of Apple Inc.

⁷⁹ A phrase used by the fellow associates of Jobs which implied his manipulation capacity.

⁸⁰ Walter Isaacson, *Steve Jobs*, (United States: Simon and Schuster, 2011), 108.

3.2.1. Happiness

Happiness implies the state of joy and satisfaction. Humans always tend towards happiness. When we are in the state of happiness our body and mind functions in a profound unity and we are able to approach life positively.⁸¹ In the economic behavior, there are companies who are more concerned about the emotional stability and positivity of the employee than the academic qualifications. They initiate rewarding mechanisms for the employees who deal cordially and jovially work with associates because those employees can more successfully achieve the targets which the company demands of them.

3.2.2. Guilt

Guilt is an emotion which is induced when we have done a specific act which is forbidden. The intensity of guilt will be more when we have done that act to our close intimates. We also feel guilty when fail to meet the expected standard of interpersonal relationships.⁸² Guilt is having its impact on economic behavior. People who were guilty are more involved in helping behaviors like donating money for welfare funds⁸³

3.2.3. Envy

Envy is a negative emotion which is aimed at the good fortune of others. Envy is always associated with comparison. We are envious because we are not satisfied with what we have and seeing the prosperity of others gives us a discomfort.⁸⁴ In the economic behavior, we can see envious behaviors in bureaucracies and institutions. Sometimes this destabilizes the company and reduce its growth rate. A sense of unity and homely feeling is lost due to envious behavior.

3.3. Emotional Intelligence

The term ‘Emotional Intelligence’ was coined by Peter Salovey and John D Mayer in 1990 and they illustrate it as “a form of social intelligence that involves the ability to monitor one’s own and others’ feeling and emotions, to discriminate among

⁸¹ John Antony, *Emotions in Counselling*, 132.

⁸² Ibid, 208.

⁸³ Andrew Michena, *Social psychology* (Florida: Harcourt Brace Jovanovich, 1986),302.

⁸⁴ John Antony, *Emotions in Counselling*, 165.

them, and to use this information to guide one's thinking and action".⁸⁵ The main aim of emotional intelligence is to guide a person to a stable life and to help the individual to cope up with the emotional challenges of the daily life situations. It also looks forward in merging analytical reasoning and logical judgement with emotional competence⁸⁶. Therefore, emotional intelligence can assist the human person to make decisions, which are appropriate.

A key feature with emotional intelligence is its role in maintaining relationships with people. As emotions have an extrinsic function of unifying people in the society, managing emotional tendencies will help in framing a well-organized society.⁸⁷ Here is an excerpt: "All of these emotions are rooted in an intellectual concern- a concern about one's social wellbeing and survival"⁸⁸.

There is also the relevance of having the topic of emotional intelligence in the academic curriculum, since the study of emotions from childhood will help in better understanding. Just as the intellectual education progresses on one side, emotional education can also take place on the other side. Thus, the students are able to think for themselves (Intellectual Education) and feel for themselves (Emotional Education).⁸⁹ There were also debates regarding whether emotional intelligence is relevant or not. A famous psychologist named Bar On⁹⁰ found out that the whole personality of the individual determines the life's success than mere cognitive intelligence. That is the reason why only a few individuals succeed in life.

There are different models of emotional intelligence. The first one is the Ability Model. This model has a theme that states that emotions contain storage information of relationships. The relationships could be of any type. It could include both people and objects. For example, for a person who is dangerous is feared and an object that is lovable is liked. This information can be remembered or imagined. Emotions act as felt signals and emotional intelligence helps to understand the meaning of this information

⁸⁵ Cary Cherniss, *Emotional Intelligence: what it is and why it matters*, (New Orleans: Rutgers University, April 2000), 4. https://secure.tutorsglobe.com/Atten_files/237_What-it-is-and-why-it-matters.pdf (Accessed on 10-09-2024).

⁸⁶ John Antony, *Emotions in Counselling* (India: Anugraha Publications, September 2005), 97.

⁸⁷ Refer chapter 1, Emotions, concept.

⁸⁸ Barbara B. Brown, *Super Mind* (n.p.: Bantam Books, March 1980), 94.

⁸⁹ John MacMurray, *Reason and Emotion* (Great Britain: Faber and Faber, 1935), 70.

⁹⁰ The psychologist who coined the term 'emotional quotient' as the measure of emotional intelligence in his doctoral dissertation.

and to use them cognitive processes like logical thinking and reasoning.⁹¹ There is another model called Trait Model which focuses on the theme that emotions can be better understood by analyzing personality traits. It is known as trait (EI) or emotional self-efficacy.⁹² The proponents of this model argue that emotional intelligence is not a real intelligence and will be difficult to analyze since there is an element of subjectivity in them. The Trait Model progresses on the concept of the emotional self, which is described as the felt perceptions located at the lower levels of personality hierarchies. It emphasizes on the particular personality traits, which are included in the perception and regulation of emotions.⁹³

Each of these models of emotional intelligence have their own methods of measuring emotional intelligence. This would include questionnaire and assessment tools that are designed to analyze the emotions of the candidate. For example, “Emotional Choice Theory which is developed to access the emotional competencies and social behaviors uses the assessment tool which includes a 110 item questionnaire includes 4 clusters and they are namely self-awareness, social awareness, self-management, social skills”.⁹⁴

3.4. Economic Decisions

There are many factors, which influence the human decision-making; and emotions are one of them. There is a natural tendency to deny the role of emotions in optimal judgements but they play a very important role in the process. Epistemological errors can be a cause of poor decisions. It could be corrected. The emotional problems are not that easy to correct and analyze. There is a need for the individual to come to a full self-awareness and to realize the mental struggles of human life.

⁹¹ Aljoscha Neubauer, Herald Freudenthaler, *Models of EI* (n.p.:2003), 40. https://www.researchgate.net/profile/Aljoscha-Neubauer-2/publication/232490406_Models_of_Emotional_Intelligence/links/5a5f0c9daca272d4a3e0be9c/Models-of-Emotional-Intelligence.pdf (Accessed on 15-08-2024).

⁹² John D. Mayer, Emotional intelligence as a standard intelligence, *Emotion* Vol 1, No: 3 (n.p.: 2003), 234. https://www.researchgate.net/profile/AljoschaNeubauer2/publication/232490406_Models_of_Emotional_Intelligence/links/5a5f0c9daca272d4a3e0be9c/Models-of-Emotional-Intelligence.pdf (Accessed on 15-08-2024).

⁹³ Nitasha Singh Borah, *Emotional Intelligence*, 67.

⁹⁴ Jeffrey M. Conte, A review and critique of emotional intelligence measures, *Journal of Organisational Behavior* (n.p.: John Wiley and sons, 2005), 434. <https://citeseerx.ist.psu.edu/document?repid=rep1&type=pdf&doi=338d720e068229ff611f521cd3b61961d5f530d6> (Accessed on 02-09-2024).

There is always a tendency to do what we feel like. Likes and feelings last for a short period. So, we tend to slip away from doing what is apt. It is necessary to have some basic convictions on the aspects of life. These convictions are rooted on emotions. For example, if the person is convinced, that he or she is destined to be an athlete; the person will be 'happy' in abstaining from junk food and will be 'sad' when the practices are cancelled. The individual will be 'thrilled' when there is progress and so on. Emotions are a source of energy to unlock the hidden potential in the human person. The convictions, which are based on belief, can be boosted with the emotional power. This would help us to make better choices.

Emotions add a flavour to our lives. Without them, human life would have been monotonous and ugly. They have their unique contribution in art, literature and poetry. Just as making recipes in kitchen, the emotional recipe should be in a balance to harness its full potential. A slight change in any component could ruin the whole system. Therefore, a person should be mentally sound before going into any decision-making process.

When it comes to decision making there is a hermeneutical approach too. There are no absolutely right or wrong decisions. They are interpreted from a particular perspective. The ethical dimension of the individual prompts to judge whether it is right or wrong. Individual decisions are prone to be biased since there is a chance of relativism to creep into our choices. Decisions taken by a group of emotionally sound people can bring enlightenment. They provide different angles of viewing the phenomenon.

Conclusion

The advances in psychology have helped in understanding economic behavior in a clearer way. There are some basic economic behaviors like emotion work, emotional action and emotional contagion are very evident in organizations. Indeed, there is an influence of emotions like happiness, guilt and envy in economic behavior. Taking important decisions is the collective responsibility of individuals in the administrative sectors. It is also the responsibility of every professional to make sound decisions. Emotional intelligence is very relevant in this modern society especially for understanding how much we are capable in making good decisions. An emotionally

sound person can make economic decisions. Thus, we will be able to avoid confusions and be better people.

General Conclusion

This thesis went through an enquiry into the world of emotions, which are essential and vital for human beings. Every ordinary person goes through a bundle of emotional experiences every day. They add a beauty to our lives. The philosophy of emotions is evolving according to the contributions of science and technology. It is common to make statements, which begin with 'I like', or 'I don't like' and 'I feel...' What we do and do not do has got a lot to do with our emotions. Even our character is related with emotions. The emotional advantages, which help in various fields; especially decision-making bodies, art, business and various enterprises, should replace the traditional view of considering the emotions as hindrance. Being emotional is being human.

The principal question of this thesis was whether emotions have any role in the decision making process. Through the first chapter I wanted to give a holistic view on the concept of emotions which is important for further research. In the second chapter, I attempted find a link between the process of decision making and emotions in the background of behavioral economics which gives a clear aspect on the role of certain emotions in making choices. The third chapter I examine the role of emotions in economic behavior through which I connect emotions with economic decision making.

It had always been a challenge for this present generation to calm their minds when they are in the pursuit of achieving their own personal goals. Sometimes they get exhausted in this process. Some people are getting isolated from the society because of the influence of the internet. Thus, there is also a steep increase in mental disorders, which arose due to the excess pressure on the human mind. The personal emotions are given more priority. Self- satisfaction and happiness are sought and there are decisions made for selfish motives. Corruption of the government sectors and poor management of public resources are the effects of it. Instinctual behavior can cause chaos and destruction in the society. Emotions can be compared to a knife with a sharp blade. Knife can be used useful purposes like cutting vegetables or for beautifying sculptures or killing people and destroying the moral structure of the society. Emotional stability leads to economic decisions while emotional instability leads to absurdity and confusion. Therefore, the emotions have a great role in the economic decision making of the individual.

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